The National Archives reference FO 17/675

No 171

Peking
8. August 1874

My Lord,

The Japanese Minister,
Yamigawara Sakimitsu, has
arrived in Peking on the 30th
July. On the 4th Instant he
called on me - The visit was
only a visit of ceremony, but
it was of some length and I
took occasion to ask for the
Earl of Derby latest

No.
Peking - 8. August
Rec'd 1st Oct.
Answered
No 170.

Rec'd Arrival
Audience of Belgian
Minister.
Directed a Standing
delay

2nd The same to
Ch. Consuls
Canton

Mr Scott
Shanghai

518

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latest news of the Formosan affair,
which I said of course interested
us all more or less; adding
that the Tsung li Yamên had
sent me all the correspondence
that had passed between the
Chinese and Japanese regarding
it. The Minister Yanagawara
seemed somewhat disturbed
by my allusion to it. He said
that he had received one —,
despatch

despatch about it en route from
Tientsin — This I have since —
ascertained was a despatch in the
sense of the circular addressed
by the Yamên to the Legations on
the 2nd Instant, translation of
which forms Enclosure, No 1. in my
Despatch No of this date. I
did not press for more information
as I saw how little disposed he
was to give it, but changed the
subject

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subject and Yamagawara subsequently went into the question of rendering here, the steps necessary to secure a Legation, expense of rent or purchase &c with enough of interest to justify the conclusion, unless he was acting a part, that he seriously contemplates the establishment of a Legation in permanence at Peking. This would be, in some sort augury of a desire for peace, so far

far as Japan is concerned. It must be remembered indeed that, as the Japanese choose to put it, there is no casus belli between China and Japan, — the contention of the latter being that she has invaded territory which China last year admitted to be beyond the reach of Chinese Authority. The new Ministers attitude otherwise has been in perfect consistency with the hypothesis that there is nothing

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nothing to disturb peaceful relations.

The Prince of Ring has been for a few days on leave, - it is stated, because he was — indisposed. His Highness was consequently not at the Yamen when Yamigawara paid his first visit on the 7th Instant, I.S. yesterday. He presented the duplicate of his letter of Credence, however, and asked for his audience. He was told, I am given

given to understand, that as the Ministers of other Powers were entitled to an Audience so would he be.

The Ministers who received him then passed on to the question of Formosa but except a reiteration of the proposition that China by her own admission has, in effect, no jurisdiction over the territory lately occupied by Japanese Troops

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troops, they do not seem to have
drawn much from the Japanese

I have the honor to be
with the highest respect,
My Lord,
Your Lordship's most obedient,
Humble servant,
Thomas Francis Wade

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1874
Peking - 8. August
Rec^d Wade
ct^o 171.

rec^d Nov 17

Japanese Minister,
arrival of. - conversation with.

Sir Thomas Wade
& Mr Giquel
Circulate

519.

52

No 172

Peking
11. August 1874

My Lord,

I have the honor to forward a number of the Chinese Recorder, a Missionary Periodical recently received, and to request Your Lordship's attention to the article, page 66, entitled "Mongolia's two Neighbours, Russia and China".

If I am not mistaken as to the Authorship, I can vouch for the fair-mindedness of the writer. It hardly needs his pen, indeed, to establish the advantage at which Russia must

&c, Earl of Derby

I stand

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